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Business Application and Line-of-Business System Issues

ERP, CRM, HR, finance and other core application errors, slowness and access faults

Default priority: P2 High (P1 if a critical business process is stopped)**Target response / resolution:** Respond in 15 min / update hourly**Handled by:** Tier 1 triage, then Application support**Scope**

Use this instruction when a business application is not working, is slow, or gives errors, such as ERP, CRM, payroll, HR, or finance systems. The goal is to find out quickly whether the fault is local, the user's account, or the application itself.

Related instructions: WI-09 Access Requests, WI-20 Browser and Web Apps, WI-04 Software

Common symptoms

- Error message on login or when saving a record
- Application is slow or times out
- A report or batch job fails
- Data is missing or displays incorrectly
- A page works for some users but not others

Information to collect

- Name of the application and the function being used
- Exact error message, screenshot, and the time it occurred
- Number of users affected and which departments
- Whether it worked before, and any recent change or upgrade

Resolution steps

- 1 Check for known issues.** Look in the incident list and the status page for a known outage or planned maintenance. If one exists, link the ticket and give the user the update.
- 2 Establish the scope.** Ask whether colleagues have the same problem. One user points to the account or device. Many users point to the application or infrastructure.
- 3 Reproduce the fault.** Try the same steps on your own test account or the user's device with remote assistance. Note exactly where it fails.
- 4 Check the user's account.** Verify the account is active and the user has the right role, licence, and permissions. Check for recent changes to roles.
- 5 Check the client side.** Clear the browser cache, try another browser, test from another device, and check for required plug-ins or client updates.
- 6 Capture evidence for support.** Record error text, timestamps, user IDs, transaction names, and screenshots. Include steps to reproduce. Good evidence shortens the fix time.
- 7 Escalate and keep the user informed.** Pass the ticket to the application support team with the evidence. Agree on a workaround if there is one, and update the user at the agreed intervals.

Escalate when

- Multiple users affected, or a critical process (payroll, month-end close, order entry) is blocked
- Data appears wrong, lost, or exposed (raise a security and data incident)
- The fault started right after a release or change

Resolution and closure

- Record the cause (account, client, application, infrastructure) and the fix
- Link to the problem record if the issue has happened before
- Close after the user confirms the application works and the business process is complete

Quick troubleshooting reference

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
Cannot log in to the application	Account locked, role missing, or SSO fault	Check the account and role, then test SSO sign-in to another app.
Error when saving a record	Missing mandatory data, permissions, or a bug	Capture the message, test with another record, and send to application support.
Application very slow	Server load, network, or a large query	Check monitoring, test from another location, and report timings.
Report returns no data	Filters, permissions, or a failed job	Check filter settings and data access. Check the batch job status with the application team.
Works for others, not for this user	Profile or browser data	Clear the cache, try a private window, and re-create the user's profile if needed.

Suggested wording for the user

Open	<i>"I can see this is stopping your work. Can you tell me exactly which screen you are on and what you see?"</i>
During	<i>"I have passed the details to the application team, and I will update you every hour until we have an answer. In the meantime, here is a workaround you can use."</i>
Close	<i>"The application team has fixed the issue. Please try the process again and confirm it works before I close this ticket."</i>

Good practice

Do

- Capture error text and timestamps
- Check for outages before deep troubleshooting
- Provide workarounds where possible
- Update users at agreed intervals

Do not

- Do not change application data or settings without the application owner
- Do not share screenshots with sensitive data outside the ticket
- Do not guess at the cause when evidence is missing
- Do not close on an unconfirmed fix

Worked example

Several accounts payable staff cannot post invoices in the finance system on the day before month-end.

Ticket note field	Entry
Issue reported	Invoice posting returns 'Authorization object missing' for 6 users.
Checks performed	Started at 09:40. Roles unchanged. A role update was deployed at 09:30.
Cause	Role change removed a permission object.
Action taken	Escalated as P1 with evidence. Application team restored the permission within the hour.
Result	Posting works. Change reviewed and a problem record created.

Frequently asked questions

Q. How do we decide between P1 and P2 for an application fault?

Use the business impact. If a critical process such as payroll, order entry, or month-end is stopped for many people with no workaround, treat it as P1.

Q. What evidence should we always collect before escalating?

Exact error text, time, user ID, steps to reproduce, number of users affected, and any recent changes. Screenshots help, but avoid sensitive data.

Q. Can we give a user temporary access to work around a fault?

Only with approval from the application owner, with an expiry date, and recorded in the ticket.

Analyst checklist

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| ☐ Check for known issues | ☐ Capture evidence for support |
| ☐ Establish the scope | ☐ Escalate and keep the user informed |
| ☐ Reproduce the fault | ☐ Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| ☐ Check the user's account | ☐ User confirmed the issue is resolved |
| ☐ Check the client side | |

Preventing repeat tickets

- Test role changes in a non-production system
- Publish release and maintenance calendars to the Service Desk
- Keep a list of business-critical periods
- Maintain runbooks for common application errors